drones connecting cities, facilitating efficient and interconnected logistics to maintain a balance between ground-level operations and high-altitude flights," he discloses.

The company is currently focused on designing the first version of its commercial logistics vehicle, a 100kg payload unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV) with vertical takeoff and a fully electric engine.

According to Dacharla, "Building drones, and especially a network of drones, involves significant expenses and requires extensive R&D and technical support. By working as a design services provider, we are strengthening our abilities, while funding our activities to work towards our end goal."

(L to R) Rohith Dacharla, Founder, and Venkata Kamesh, Co-founder, Parova Drone Technologies

Navigating through challenges related to budget constraints, Dacharla reiterates his end-goal as developing Bajrang, but adds that the immediate focus is to explore potential collaborations with companies specialising in telecommunications and long-range transmission to engage in transfer of technology agreements, to streamline its R&D efforts, through MoUs or patent licensing arrangements.

"This will allow us to implement or manufacture their technologies on their behalf. We've received proposals from global companies seeking manufacturing facilities in India, and we are open to facilitating and operating such facilities for them. We are actively considering such proposals," says Dacharla.

—*Yashasvini Razdan*

3 ELLOTOR'S VERSATILE 'E-TRIKE' EV OFFERING MANY OPTIONS

Meerut-based startup Ellotor has developed an e-Trike, an electric tricycle, which can be operated by anyone over ten years old

Founded in 2023, during the G20 Meerut Investors Summit by Varun Kaushik and Dr Madhuri Gupta, the EV startup Ellotor offers a unique e-trike with a detachable seat. It can be operated by anyone beyond ten years of age. Individuals with special disabilities in their legs and hands can also use this e-trike.

The Uttar Pradesh government's startup promotion department provided an initial funding of 1.1 million rupees for the project. Ellotor initially introduced an e-trike for senior citizens and, within half a year, the company delivered nearly 20 units across 11 different states.

For commercial use, Ellotor has developed e-trikes with multiple applications and attachments. These can serve as a stand-up bike, a comfortable seated bike, a trolley attachment, a delivery vehicle, a portable refrigerator, an advertisement vehicle, vehicle for food items' deliveries, and as a street food vending option.

Kaushik emphasises that the major benefits and USP of the innovation lie in its self-balancing capability. It is 35% more cost-efficient compared to other fossil-fuel and electric vehicles in the market. The running cost for 100km comes to 11 rupees; maintenance costs are 95% less. Additionally, the product is exempt from RTO registration and other taxes.

The EV is powered by a lithium-ion battery and operates on a 250-watt DC motor with a payload capacity of up to 150kg. With a speed of 25 km/hour, you can cover up to 100km with it on a single charge.

"With our successful product deliveries in 11 states across India, our current focus is on meeting individual demands," says Madhuri.

Dr Madhuri Gupta and Varun Kaushik, Founders, Ellotor

"It is in high demand among fleet owners for local market product sales, personal transportation, franchise-based operations, rental bike models, and corporate in-house movement. The product can also be scaled up for use in university campuses, such as IITs, NITs, central and state universities, IT parks, tourist destinations, hospitals, residential societies, and farmhouses," she adds.

Ellotor is actively seeking distributors and dealers, targeting fleet owners and rental bike models. "We have explored potential partnerships in Dubai and Malaysia, and are looking at global expansion," says Madhuri. EFY

—*Nitisha Dubey*